

Mozilla to stop development of Firefox OS for mobiles by May

Mozilla will be ending its development of Firefox OS for mobiles by May this year. This is three years after the OS was launched to challenge mobile platforms like Apple and Google. Due to the drop in its popularity, the company has decided to end further development of this OS.

Also, makers are hesitant in launching new smartphones that have Firefox OS due to fewer features when compared to Android.



According to George Roter, a developer with Mozilla, the conditions are not great for Firefox with other platforms having already set up a huge user base along with apps libraries. There are millions of apps in Google's Play store and Mozilla is not even close to that level. This has resulted in it failing to win the race for commercial smartphones.

Henceforth, Mozilla is going to focus on the development of open source software for several Internet of Things devices. These will vary from connected cars to light bulbs. Roter also said that they have thus far finished three projects, including smart TV applications, with more projects in the pipeline.

The development and support for the OS is going to end by May 2016, after the upcoming Firefox OS 2.6 has been released. After this, users will not be eligible for support and upgrades even if they have a Firefox enabled smartphone.

Riddell, at the Free and Open Source Software Developer's European Meeting (FOSDEM) 2016.

If you visit KDE Neon's home page, you will be surprised to find that what at first appears to be a bunch of software repositories is actually a full-featured distribution. This implies that the project will always offer Ubuntu or Kubuntu users up-to-date KDE packages as and when they are released.

As cited on the project's page, "KDE Neon is the intersection of these needs using a stable Ubuntu long-term release as its core, packaging the hottest software fresh from the KDE Community ovens. Compute knowing you have a solid foundation and enjoy the features you experience in the world's most customisable desktop."

What is noteworthy is that KDE Neon is an official KDE project, as well as a community effort. The project is aimed at providing its users with live and installable mediums that people can use for installing an Ubuntu based operating system, powered by the latest KDE technologies on their personal computers.

Open sourced Seesaw load balancer from Google



Google has made an announcement that it will be open sourcing Seesaw, which is a Linux based load balancing system. The code, written in Google's Go language, can be viewed on GitHub under the Apache licence.

As stated in an announcement by Google's site reliability engineer, Joel Sing, who is working on the company's corporate infrastructure, Google was utilising two varied load balancing systems in 2012. However, both of them came up with diverse sets of management and stability challenges. Hence, to rectify these, he and his team started to look for a new solution, and as the ones available at the time didn't meet with Google's requirements, they began writing their own.

As one of the platforms was already using the Linux Virtual Server (LVS) for network-level load balancing, the team stayed with it. Sing states, "After a period of concentrated development effort, we completed and successfully deployed Seesaw v2 as a replacement for both existing platforms. Overall, it allowed us to increase service availability and reduce management overhead."

A point that must be noted is that even though the project comes from Google, the open sourced version is not an official Google product; hence, one should not expect the company to offer any official support.

Microsoft's Azure Stack: A cloud for your data centre



Microsoft's Azure Stack is a cloud platform running within the customer's own data centres. It is a key focus for Microsoft in its plans for a hybrid cloud system. The Azure Stack has the same code that is used in Azure to run a stack

locally as well as another in the cloud. Microsoft feels that customers will like its new approach as it helps them in familiarising themselves with development and management in either scenario.